

MOJALEFA LAWRENCE LETSOARA

Cybersecurity Analyst | SOC Monitoring, Detection Engineering,
Windows & Linux

Location: Johannesburg, Gauteng, South
Africa

[LinkedIn](#)
[GitHub](#)

Profile

My path into cybersecurity has been through building things and breaking them myself. Worked on a domain-joined Windows SOC lab, a hardened Linux server, and live Microsoft Sentinel and Splunk pipelines rather than through a classroom. I like the kind of problem where the first explanation turns out to be wrong and you have to keep testing until you find the real cause; that's basically how I ended up re-debugging the same network peering issue three separate times while building out a hybrid Azure lab.

Day to day I work on Windows Server and endpoint troubleshooting in a live IT support role. Outside of that I've written formal incident reports off simulated ransomware and web-attack investigations in Splunk, and built detection rules in Sentinel mapped to MITRE ATT&CK. CompTIA Security+ and CySA+ certified plus a run of Microsoft Azure and security certifications, all self-study, roughly how I'd approach picking up the tools and domains I haven't touched yet (Nessus/Qualys, IAM platforms, firewall administration) if given the chance to learn them on the job.

Technical Skills

- **Security Monitoring & Incident Response:** Microsoft Sentinel, Splunk Enterprise, Wazuh, Incident Triage & Investigation, Threat Hunting, MITRE ATT&CK, False Positive & Alert Validation, Root Cause Analysis / P1 Reporting
- **Detection Engineering:** KQL, SPL, Custom Analytics/Detection Rule Development
- **Operating Systems:** Windows Server, Windows 10/11, Linux (Ubuntu), auditd, SSH hardening
- **Networking & Identity:** TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, Routing & Connectivity Troubleshooting, Active Directory
- **Cloud & Microsoft Security:** Microsoft Azure (Sentinel, Monitor, Log Analytics), Microsoft Defender XDR, Azure Monitor Agent, Data Collection Rules
- **Security Fundamentals (via Security+/CySA+ study):** CIA Triad, Least Privilege, Zero Trust principles, MFA, PKI & Encryption Basics
- **Scripting & Version Control:** PowerShell, Bash (Azure Cloud Shell scripting), Git

Certifications

- **CompTIA CySA+ ce,** CompTIA, Jun 2026 – Jun 2029
- **CompTIA Security+ ce,** CompTIA, Jun 2026 – Jun 2029
- **Microsoft Certified: Security Operations Analyst Associate (SC-200),** Jul 2026
- **Microsoft Certified: Security, Compliance & Identity Fundamentals (SC-900),** Mar 2026
- **Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900),** Mar 2026
- **Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator Associate (AZ-104),** In progress, retake scheduled 20 October 2026
- **Microsoft Certified: Cloud and AI Security Engineer Associate (SC-500),** Scheduled 21 October 2026

Key Projects

Enterprise Hybrid SOC Lab, Multi-VM Azure Environment

Jul 2026 – Present, ongoing

- Building a hybrid, multi-VM Azure environment across a 4-spoke network architecture, including a domain-joined Windows endpoint and a hardened Linux server (Ubuntu, auditd, SSH hardening).
- Diagnosed and resolved a recurring cross-network connectivity issue caused by non-transitive VNet peering, applying the same systematic fix as new network segments were added.
- Deployed and verified live data ingestion across Microsoft Sentinel, Splunk Enterprise and Wazuh in parallel, alongside Zeek and Suricata for network traffic monitoring.

Tools: Azure, Microsoft Sentinel, Splunk Enterprise, Wazuh, Zeek, Suricata, Linux (Ubuntu), Windows Server, Git, Bash

Stonegate SOC, Microsoft Sentinel Incident Response Simulation

Jun 2026

- Designed, deployed and configured an enterprise-style Microsoft Sentinel SOC environment in Azure.
- Developed custom KQL analytics rules to detect brute-force RDP attacks, mapped to MITRE ATT&CK T1110.
- Investigated and closed 18 security incidents through validation, analysis, prioritisation and documented resolution.

Tools: Microsoft Sentinel, Azure Monitor, KQL, PowerShell, MITRE ATT&CK

Conti Ransomware Investigation, Splunk SIEM

Mar 2026

- Investigated a simulated Conti ransomware compromise using Splunk, analysing 28,000+ events across Windows Security, Sysmon and IIS logs.
- Reconstructed the full attack chain and identified three exploited CVEs, a web shell and credential harvesting via LSASS injection; produced a formal SOC investigation and escalation report with prioritised remediation steps.

Tools: Splunk Enterprise, Sysmon, Windows Event Logs, SPL

Threat Detection & Log Analysis, Splunk SIEM

Feb 2026

- Deployed Splunk and analysed 112 web server log entries with 9 SPL queries to uncover a multi-vector attack campaign, including unauthorised DELETE requests and a distributed botnet IP pattern.
- Produced a formal Priority 1 (P1) incident report containing investigation findings, impact assessment and remediation recommendations.

Tools: Splunk Enterprise, SPL, Dashboard Studio

Additional Microsoft Sentinel, Defender XDR, Splunk, Azure Security and malware analysis projects are available in my GitHub portfolio: github.com/Justjeff211

Professional Experience

IT Support Technician, Tfsgruops

May 2025 – Present

Phuthaditjhaba, Free State, South Africa · On-site

- Supported Windows enterprise endpoints and server infrastructure across production environments.
- Investigated authentication, networking and system issues using Event Viewer and Windows Event Log analysis, following defined procedures and escalation paths.
- Resolved DNS, DHCP and TCP/IP connectivity issues as part of routine network troubleshooting.
- Supported endpoint security through antivirus deployment and Windows security hardening.

Radio Host & Technical Support, Q-lit Radio Station

Feb 2020 – Feb 2022

University of the Free State, Qwa Qwa Campus · Freelance

- Provided technical support and troubleshooting for Windows workstations and studio infrastructure during live broadcasts.

Volunteering

Cybersecurity Analyst | Blue Team Training, Hacking Hub

Oct 2025 – Present

- Participating in structured Blue Team training covering threat detection, incident response, SIEM operations and malware analysis.
- First community member outside the founder to complete the Immersive Labs learning pathway.